



NETWORKED COMPUTER SYSTEMS ADMINISTRATION

2ND YEAR HIGHER VOCATIONAL TRAINING

COMMUNICATIVE SKILLS IN A FOREIGN LANGUAGE (ENGLISH) *ENGLISH FOR IT*

Module 2: Customer service: request feedback

- 01 Grammar: Negative Future Tenses
- 02 Listening: Hearing anger from customers
- 03 Grammar: Polite requests
- 04 Reading: email from a customer
- 05 Writing: writing an answer as feedback to a customer

Grammar: Negative future tenses

In network engineering we can use **present continuous** to express both positive and negative ideas. What can it be used for?

- Emphasise decision: *We are not having the support training course, as we're still in short numbers*

We can also use going to. What for?

- Intention to do (or not) something: *We are not going to run a training course just because people think it is necessary.*

But... what is the difference between these two?

The difference between the **present continuous** and **be going to** is not really big.

Basic difference:

- After a decision has been made, you say you are not doing it
- If you express spontaneously that you have no intention of doing it, you say you are not going to do it.



Let's try the following exercises before going through the exercises of you module...

- LET'S TRY THIS KAHOOT

The Kahoot logo is displayed in a large, bold, purple font. The word "Kahoot" is centered within a light gray rectangular background.

BEFORE LISTENING: IDIOMS and EXPRESSIONS

- **Can't get a word in edgeway:** you are unable to contribute to a conversation because other people are talking too much
- **On our end:** from our side, from our perspective, indicating that the action, responsibility, or situation being discussed pertains to the speaker's or their group's part in a given context. professional settings to differentiate one party's role or viewpoint from another's.

BEFORE LISTENING: IDIOMS and EXPRESSIONS

- **To cool down:** to lower the temperature of something, become calmer after being angry or excited.
- **The nature of the job:** fundamental qualities, including the specific duties, skills required, work environment, and overall purpose of the position.

BEFORE LISTENING: IDIOMS and EXPRESSIONS

- **There's no harm in asking:** it's worthwhile to ask for something because it won't cause any problems, and it might lead to a positive outcome.
- **To feel more equipped:** to feel more prepared, capable, and furnished with the necessary skills, knowledge, resources, or tools to handle a particular task, situation, or challenge effectively.

SPEAKING PRACTICE: EXPRESSING ANGER

TODAY'S WORK: INDIVIDUAL

I Can't Believe This Customer Did That!

You are an IT technician or system administrator. A customer or user has caused a problem or complained unfairly. You have 1 minute to express your frustration about what happened. Be clear, emotional, but also professional – as if you're talking to a colleague, not to the customer directly.

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POSSIBLE ISSUES

- **The network is slow because...**

The customer installed random software on all the company computers.

- **They say the system is useless, but...**

They never attended the training session you prepared for them.

- **The website crashed because...**

The customer updated something on the server without telling you.

- **They lost all their data because...**

The client refused to pay for backup service — now their hard drive has failed



SPEAKING: USEFUL LANGUAGE

- I can't believe this happened again!
- I told them several times to...
- It's so frustrating when...
- They expect me to fix it instantly, but...
- Honestly, I don't understand how...
- Next time, I'm definitely going to...



REQUESTS: BEING POLITE

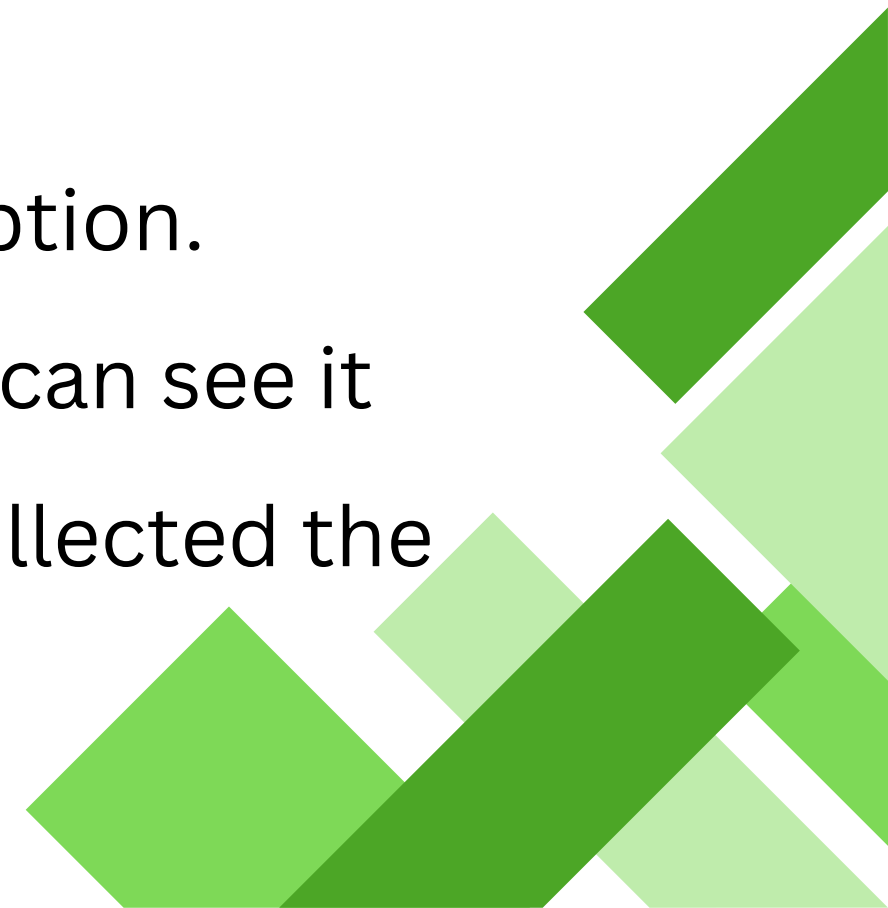
When we make a request in English we need to pay attention to two things:

- If you know a person well or not
- If the request is urgent

1. **We know the person and it's urgent:** IMPERATIVE. *Delay the purchase for next week.*
2. **We know the person but not urgent:** add CAN. *Can you delay the purchase for next week?*
3. **The person is very important, like a boss or superior:** add COULD. *Could you delay the purchase for next week?*
 - a. You can also use WOULD as question. *Would you delay the purchase for next week?*
 - b. Or also as a polite sentence. *It would be great if you could delay the purchase for next week.*

What types of polite requests can we have?

- **COMMAND:** Ask your client if she can see it displayed in the chat section correctly. // Please collect the logs yourself.
- **OBLIGATION STATEMENT:** I need you to ask the customer for the logs.
- **SUGGESTION:** You should ask the customer to take screenshots.
- **QUERY:** Could you ask your client if she can see it displayed in the chat section properly? // Can you please ask the customer for the logs? // Why don't you collect the logs yourself?
- **PREFERENCE:** I think asking the customer for the logs is the best option.
- **HINT:** I was wondering if you might be able to ask your client if she can see it displayed in the chat section correctly. // It would be best if you collected the logs yourself. // I'm so thirsty!



Reading: vocabulary preparation

- It's highly advisable... *es altamente recomendable...*
- This is not a technical problem but a feature... *No es un fallo, es intencionado/es así*
- When they find out how it works... *cuando sepamos cómo es...*
- It is essential that everyone attend. *Se requiere que todo el mundo asista.*
- Failing to do that will result in. *Fallar en esto tendrá como resultado que...*
- We won't be able to ..., since... *No podremos..., porque/puesto*



WRITING: ANSWER AS FEEDBACK TO A CUSTOMER

Professional replies show respect for the sender's time and effort and sets the tone for future conversations. For example, majority of employees believe clear and respectful communication is key to teamwork.

STRUCTURE

- **Greeting:** *Dear [name], / Dear [Mr. / Mrs.,]*
- **Reference the original email:** *Thank you for your email regarding [topic] // I appreciate your feedback/comments on [add the topic].* This way you'll keep the flow of the conversation.
- **Body:** Be brief and go straight to the point. Address the specific questions or requests that the customer demanded in the original email. DO NOT go off topic. You can do this in 1 paragraph or in 2 paragraphs if you want to address two different parts of the original email.
- **Closing and call to action:** *Best regards, // Sincerely, + Please let me know if you need more information // Looking forward to hearing back from you soon/by [date]*

WRITING: EXTRA TIPS

How to reply to rude emails



- Be professional and stay calm: take a few minutes to cool down
- Address the points and ignore the rudeness: show you're not getting distracted by the unprofessional comments.
- Offer solutions or next steps: you show you're looking for a positive outcome
- When needed, seek help or escalate: If the rudeness is persistent or extreme, you may need to inform a manager or HR for further guidance.

Email etiquette basics



- Use simple language: It makes it easier for your recipient to quickly get your point.
- Be tone aware: avoid excessive exclamation marks. Use “Could you please...” to be respectful
- Proof before you send: will help you ensure your message is polished and professional.
- Know when to use formal or informal language: Emails to clients or higher ups may require formal language.

WRITING: COMMON MISTAKES



- **Long or complicated messages**

How to fix: Keep your message brief, focus on one topic per email. Short paragraphs, bullet points.

- **Forgetting attachments**

How to fix: Before you hit send, double check for attachments by scanning your email for “attached” or “enclosed”.

- **Vague subject line**

How to fix: For example instead of “Quick question” try “Question about next week’s project deadline”. This will make your email stand out and increase the chances it gets opened.

- **Not proofreading for errors**

How to fix: Re-read especially for names, dates and other important info. Check spelling or read the email out loud to catch any remaining errors before you send.

- **Ignoring the tone**

How to fix: Add a friendly opening and closing and use phrases like “Could you please...” or “Thanks for...” to keep it polite.



Re: [Complaint topic]

A TEMPLATE



Hello [Name],
Dear [name]
Dear [Mr./Mrs. surname]

Thanks for getting in touch about [mention issue]. Sorry for the trouble and thanks for the feedback.

[Briefly address the issue or outline what you're doing to fix it]

Let me know if there's more I can do to help.

Best,

[Your Name]

